areas occupied by them subsequently. However, in reality, the Chinese continued to stick to their aggressive posture in Ladakh, establishing six new posts in the region: Shenhsienwan on the northern slope of the Karakoram Pass, Tienwentian near Chip Chap-la, a post each at Kongka-la, Nyagzu, Khurnak Fort and also at Spanggur itself. The Chinese call these ‘civilian checkposts’ and retain the abrogated right to object if there is ever any activity on the Indian side. On 3 March 1963, Pakistan ceded to the People’s Republic of China the 5,800-square-kilometre Shaksgam Valley ‘pending the settlement of the dispute over Kashmir’ with the Indians.

But then that is quite another story.